



MONEY YOU'RE OWED

Property Tax Appeal Kit

The free, do-it-yourself toolkit to challenge an over-assessed home — and lower your bill for years

Start here: the 5 steps

1. **Find your latest assessment notice** (NOT your tax bill) and write down the **appeal deadline printed on it** — often ~30–45 days, but it varies. This is the clock that matters.
2. **Get your property record card** from the county assessor (online or by request) and check every fact.
3. **Gather evidence** — corrected record errors, 3–5 comparable sales, photos of any damage/problems.
4. **Informal review first** — call or submit a correction to the assessor; obvious errors often get fixed with no hearing.
5. **Formal appeal** to the Board of Equalization / Assessment Appeals Board if needed; present your evidence at a short, informal hearing.

Record-card error checklist (the easiest wins)

- Square footage matches reality
- Correct number of bedrooms / bathrooms
- Lot size correct
- Basement/attic finish status correct (finished vs unfinished)
- Garage, decks, additions accurately listed (not phantom)
- Condition/grade reflects actual state (note damage, deferred maintenance)
- No structures listed that you don't actually have

Comparable-sales (comps) worksheet

Find 3–5 recent sales of homes like yours, near you, close to the assessment date.

Address	Sale date	Sale price	Sq ft	Beds/Baths	Why comparable

Your assessed value: \$ _ *Median comp price:* \$ _ Gap to argue: \$ _

Fill-in appeal letter template

Copy, fill the [brackets], and submit per your county's instructions.

[Your Name]
[Property Address]
[Parcel / Account #: _____]
[Date]

To: [County Assessor / Board of Equalization]

Re: Appeal of assessed value – Parcel [#], [Property Address]

I am the owner of the property above and respectfully appeal its [YEAR] assessed value of \$[ASSESSED VALUE]. I believe the assessment overstates the property's market value as of [VALUATION DATE], for the following reasons:

1. Property-record errors: [e.g., the record lists [X] sq ft / [N] bathrooms; the correct figures are [Y] sq ft / [M] bathrooms]. Documentation attached.
2. Comparable sales: [N] similar properties near mine sold recently for an average of \$[COMP AVG], below the assessed value. List and details attached.
3. [Optional – uniformity]: Comparable neighboring properties are assessed at lower values; see attached comparison.

Based on this evidence, I respectfully request the assessed value be reduced to approximately \$[REQUESTED VALUE].

I am available for a hearing and can provide additional documentation on request.

Sincerely,
[Your Name] · [Phone] · [Email]

Don't forget: exemptions (separate filing, often missed)

Most jurisdictions offer these — usually a **separate application** from the appeal:

- **Homestead** (primary residence)
- **Senior / over-65**
- **Veteran / disabled veteran**
- **Disability**

Check which you qualify for on your assessor's site while you're there.

Find your office + rules

Search "[your county] assessor property tax appeal" for your local deadline, forms, and record card. Every step here can be done **free, by you** — paid appeal services often take **25–50% of your first-year savings**.